political asylum hurt terribly the bilateral relations. The year 1962 was an eventful year as the two neighbours clashed. The Sino-Indian border war embittered relations further. Taking advantage of Sino-Indian animosity, Pakistan seized the opportunity to develop friendly relations with China. However, relations eased in early 1970s. Mao emphasized the re-establishment of friendship in 1970 which came to be known as 'Mao Smile'. In 1971, an Indian Table Tennis team participated in the Afro-Asian Friendship Table tennis Championship. During the Bangladesh war and India's role in it, China though was not on Indian side yet reaction was not hostile. Again a jolt in the relationship came with the Pokhran-I explosion and Sikkim's accession to India. In 1975, there was restoration of normalcy, and K.R. Narayan was designated as India's ambassador to China. Later in the 1970s economic relations witnessed a positive turn. In 1979, after 30 years of any visist by high level dignitary to China, Vajpayee visited China but midway terminated the visit and returned due to Chinese aggression of Vietnam. The year 1980 again saw differences over Chinese policies towards Afghanistan, Pakistan, Vietnam, Cambodia and boundary issues. Regarding border negotiations differences arose over whether there would be separate discussions on each sector as per Indian demand or a package deal as per Chinese intentions. In 1986, despite boundary negotiations, China intruded into Indian territory in Arunachal Pradesh.

However, a positive change in the bilateral relations with Rajiv Gandhi's visit to China. His visit to China in December 1989, was symbolic in the sense that India accepted the Chinese view-point of broadening exchange in other areas without making these developments contingent on the resolution of border issue. A much more relaxed relationship evolved after Rajiv Gandhi's visit to China, which was briefly disturbed due to the Pokhran explosion of May 1998. Nevertheless, after a short interregnum of adverse reaction between the two, normalcy resumed and relations continued on the course set by Rajiv Gandhi. Two sides arrived at a decision to constitute a Joint Working Group (JWG) to deal with boundary dispute. In December 1991, the Chinese Premier Li Peng visited India, the first visit by a Chinese PM after a lapse of 31 years. Both